

What happened to me ?

22th March 2026 - What happened to me ?

I'm 22. I'm a student majoring in Computer Science and Machine Learning. I'm graduating this year with high honors. I'm currently an intern at Samsung. Life is good. I drink amazing coffee, work in a glass tower on massive curved screen, hit the gym with great coaches, and eat at delicious restaurants. Indeed, life is good in Big Tech.

But Something feels off.

What happened to the little Lucie ? The one who, at 13, was in love with the Standard Model of particle physics and made a presentation on it ? The one who, at 15, read advanced math and physics books she barely understood ?

She's still here, still asking to unlock the mysteries of the microscopic world. A few months ago, I made a choice. I want to keep studying.

The easy choice ? The MVA - France's most prestigious master in research in Machine Learning. The master that everyone wants. The master that produces clones.

What about ... The International Master of Physics of Complex Systems ? A highly competitive master in research in physics, relatively unknown to the tech crowd, run by Europe's biggest physics organizations : Sorbonne, Politecnico de Torino, ICTP and SISSA.

I applied.

One morning at 8AM, I received an email from one of the famous professor and researcher of the master, asking for a call within 2 hours. He was surprised because I was an CS student and not a physics student.

He calls me and asks me questions about my background, my motivation, my projects. Little by little, I feel that he's interested. 'I want to do 8h of physics per day like in preparatory classes' I said at the end of the call and that made him laugh.

Three weeks later : I'm accepted.

I'm signing up for 2 years of eight hours per day, solving equations with 20 other people and I can't wait.

So, what exactly is the PCS master ?

It's not a random physics master.

It was founded in 2011. Born from a desire of Italian and French researchers to create a program of excellence to train the next generation in the sciences of complexity. The class take place in 3 different cities : Trieste, Turin and Paris.

The program is a mix of physics, computer science, mathematics, biology and neurosciences. The students are trained to be able to understand complex systems in all their forms : from the brain to the stock market & quantum mechanics.

The 400 alumni are not randomly distributed in the world. We find them doing postdocs at MIT, Oxbridge, working in big tech, in hedge funds, and top-tier research centers.

I am exactly where I'm meant to be.